jeopardy because of the emergence of a *permanent government* never envisioned by the framers of the Constitution: a federal bureaucracy that was becoming so powerful it was able to set policy and thwart the desires not only of ordinary citizens, but their elected representatives in Congress.

I'd make a note of what people told me, do some research when I got home, and then include some of the examples in my next speech. Pretty soon I had quite a few. For example, I learned the government had six programs to help poultry growers increase egg production. It also had a seventh program costing almost as much as all the six others to buy up surplus eggs.

As time went on, the portion of my speech about government began to grow longer and I began to shorten the Hollywood part. Pretty soon, it became basically a warning to people about the threat of government. Finally, the Hollywood part just got lost and I was out there beating the bushes for private enterprise.

No government has ever voluntarily reduced itself in size—and that, in a way, became my theme.

I'd emphasize that we as Americans should get together and take back the liberties we were losing; with fewer than sixty percent of the voters turning out at many national elections, it was like handing ourselves over to the enemy. Our whole system of government is based on "We the people," but if we the people don't pay attention to what's going on, we have no right to bellyache or squawk when things go wrong. So I would tell them that, and the place to start was to begin paying more attention to what was going on in their government.

I've always believed that you can't hold an audience by *reading* a speech, but when you're giving three or four or more talks a day, as I was, it's difficult to memorize every word you wanted to say; so, refining a technique I first tried